

Conception Timeline

The fertile window, tracking methods honestly compared, when tools aren't the answer, the post-conception keeper list, and your survey revisit · Module 7, Training 5

The fertile window (ASRM committee opinion, *Fertility and Sterility*)

- The window is the **six days ending on ovulation day**: sperm survive up to five days in fertile mucus; the egg about one day.
- **Intercourse every 1–2 days** across the window is optimal; more often doesn't help. Couples who simply have intercourse 2–3 times a week cover the window most cycles.
- No position helps; lying down after doesn't; timing to the hour doesn't. Long abstinence to "save up" reduces motility.
- Many common lubricants impair sperm movement; choose a fertility-friendly one if you use one.
- **Men**: no sauna, no hot tub, laptop off the lap, right through this window.

Tracking methods, honestly

METHOD	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	COST	NOTES
Cervical mucus	window is open: clear, slippery, stretchy (egg-white) in the days before ovulation	free	reliable, no equipment (ASRM)
Ovulation predictor kits	hormone surge $\approx$ 1 day before ovulation → next two days are prime	low	start a few days before you expect ovulation
Basal body temperature	rises <i>after</i> ovulation → confirms it, can't predict tonight	low	good for learning your pattern over a few cycles
Apps	most that guess from period dates got the window wrong; several missed it entirely (Setton et al., <i>Obstetrics & Gynecology</i> , 2016)	free–low	use one app to record mucus/kit/temperature data; use your body to know

When timing tools aren't the answer (see a specialist): irregular or absent cycles · 35+ and trying 6 months · 40+ · PCOS, endometriosis, thyroid disease, two or more losses, pelvic infection history, known male factor. Under 35 without conditions: 12 months (ASRM, ACOG).

My prep and timing approach (40 XP)

We'll ☐ keep it simple (2–3×/week, no tracking) ☐ watch mucus ☐ use OPKs ☐ chart temperature ☐
record in one app: _____ Specialist conversation: ☐ not yet needed ☐ booked for _____

Beyond: what carries when the test is positive

PILLAR	KEEPS	CHANGES
Nutrition	fertility plate; folic acid through at least 12 weeks (most prenats continue it); protein-first breakfast (nausea); water target up; fish 2×/week low-mercury	no raw fish; book the first prenatal visit immediately; confirm supplements with your doctor; first-trimester grace: eat what stays down, keep folic acid, water, sleep
Movement	walks, modified strength, yoga with adjustments (ACOG encourages moderate exercise in uncomplicated pregnancy)	no long flat-on-back after the first trimester; no overheating; no fall/contact risk; talk test is law; ask your doctor / prenatal physio
Stress	breathing, meditation, sleep routine, gratitude share, emotion wheel, coping plan	perinatal mental-health support exists; ask early
Toxins	glass, fragrance-free, filtered water, clean air, no sauna/hot tub	no alcohol at all; no smoking; review every medication/supplement with your doctor
Connection	weekly check-in, listening loop, the future letter's first reading	the check-in plans a family instead of a conception

If it takes longer: every habit is still building the next 90-day window; follow the specialist timeline; the forum and alumni group stay open.

Pre-course survey revisit (30 XP) — reread all four answers, then adjust

THEN	NOW
My BIG WHY:	
My support:	
My heartfelt goals:	
What I will DO / BE / CHANGE:	
How far the person who wrote the original has come:	

Community

The forum stays open · alumni group: facebook.com/groups/babysteps-alumni · replays in the navigation bar · subscription option on the course page (there if it serves you). **Share your adjusted vision in the forum (20 XP).**

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.